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Space Exploration Technologies Corp. | North America

A 'Heavenly' Hedge to DC NIMBYism?

AI NIMBYism has emerged as an impediment to terrestrial datacenter development. Beyond first principle operating benefits (free energy/real estate/cooling), the celestial ‘backyard’ can help address the moratorium risk.

Please see here for our SpaceX Initiation: SpaceX: AI’s Final Frontier; Initiate at Overweight, PT \$300 (7 Jul 2026)

Recent anti-AI NIMBYism examples in the US:

- No US state has actually banned AI datacenters.
- June 2026: New York legislature passes 1-year statewide moratorium on large datacenters (20MW+).
- AI datacenter moratoriums have been introduced in 14 states — Georgia, Maine, Maryland, Michigan, Minnesota, New Hampshire, New York, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, South Carolina, South Dakota, Vermont, Virginia and Wisconsin. Only the New York state legislature has passed the bill.
- Most of the moratorium action is at the local/municipal level. Of 155 moratoriums tracked this year, cities accounted for 60, counties for 55 with townships and towns making up the rest.
- Some more notable examples include Minneapolis (6-month pause on large facilities starting May 22nd), Denver (1-year moratorium passed May 18th), Baltimore (1-year moratorium signed into law June 16th), Reno (pause on new datacenters).
- Stratos datacenter in Utah (the Kevin O’Leary project). Originally sized at 40k acres (2x the size of Manhattan) and requiring 9 GW of power (more than the entire state’s power usage). Meeting local pushback around water usage, air quality and fire risk.
- Given the growing opposition (in particular among younger voters) to AI more broadly, the issue has been federalized: Candidates in multiple states are running on this issue, and the pushback has grown louder (in some cases actually cancelling projects). That’s been mirrored by the introduction of legislation toward these ends in Congress, from both Democrats and Republicans.
- Our Thematics and US Public Policy Team (led by Michelle Weaver and Ariana Salvatore) recently published a comprehensive overview of AI NIMBYism with public policy views, including a tracker for data center projects and moratoriums.

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Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O, SPCX US)

Space Technology | United States of America

Stock Rating	Overweight
Industry View	Attractive
Price target	\$300.00
Shr price, close (Jul 14, 2026)	\$136.08
52-Week Range	\$225.64-135.52

Fiscal Year Ending	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e
EPS (\$) **	(1.69)	0.28	2.18	6.29
Prior EPS (\$) **	-	-	-	-
P/E	NM	480.6	62.4	21.6
EPS (\$) §	-	(0.49)	0.64	3.23
Div yld (%)	-	0.0	0.0	0.0

Unless otherwise noted, all metrics are based on Morgan Stanley ModelWare framework

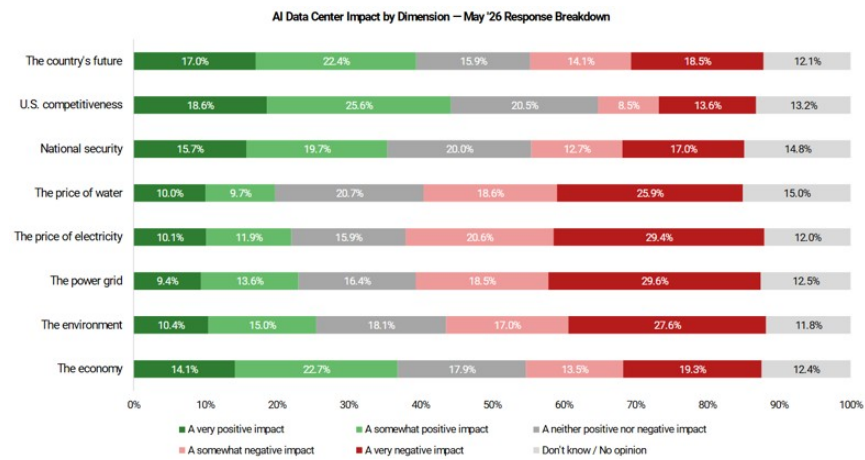
** = Based on consensus methodology
§ = Consensus data is provided by Refinitiv Estimates
e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

QUARTERLY EPS (\$)					
Quarter	2025	2026e Prior	2026e Current	2027e Prior	2027e Current
Q1	(0.18)	-	(0.84)a	-	0.54
Q2	(0.34)	-	(0.35)	-	0.55
Q3	(0.36)	-	0.27	-	0.54
Q4	(0.80)	-	0.45	-	0.56

e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates, a = Actual Company reported data

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Exhibit 1: AI Data Center Impact Survey by Dimension (May 2026)

Source: Morning Consult, AlphaWise Web Intelligence

Exhibit 2: Summary of Data Center NIMBYism

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, AlphaWise

European pushback on AI datacenters is a bit more subtle than in the US:

- **Amsterdam/Netherlands:** A moratorium on new datacenters set to run until at least 2030 with national rules restricting hyperscale projects.
- **Ireland:** De facto moratorium has been in effect for years but was eased at the end of 2025 with strict conditions such as on-site power gen.
- **Denmark:** Grid operator (Energinet) has a temporary 3-month pause on new

connections from March 2026 while they study the grid.

Recent examples of large tech firms jumping on the 'space wagon':

- **Google (Project Suncatcher):** Announced Nov 2025 with Planet Labs, planning prototype sats with TPUs for 2027.
- **NVIDIA:** Launched Vera Rubin Space Module chips in March 2026 - 'space-qualified' chips for orbital AI data centers. See recent job posting: [Principal Architect, System Software - Orbital Data Center | NVIDIA Corporation](#)
- **Amazon:** Expanding Amazon LEO (formerly Kuiper) constellation with AI/data center connectivity focus.
- **Blue Origin:** Announced TeraWave constellation of around 5,400 sats in Jan 2026 for high-speed data center connectivity. Deployment to begin late 2027 and remains in planning phase.
- **Meta:** Announced (Apr 2026) a deal to buy up to 1GW of power from startup Overview Energy to beam solar energy from satellites down to earth to help run Meta data centers.

Chinese efforts for space-based AI infrastructure:

- **CASC:** In Jan 2026, China's main aerospace contractor (China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation) announced plans to build GW-scale space-based AI data centers within 5 years.
- **15th Five-Year Plan (2026–2030):** China's national blueprint, approved by the NPC in March 2026, [writes space-based AI compute into its space-infrastructure agenda](#), calling for gigawatt-scale orbital "digital and intelligent" infrastructure by 2030. This formalizes the target CASC first outlined in January 2026 and anchors the company-level efforts above.
- **Three-Body Computing Constellation:** ADA Space (Guoxing Aerospace) and Zhejiang Lab launched the first 12 of a planned 2,800 satellites in May 2025 (5 POPS, 30 TB storage). In Nov 2025 they ran Alibaba's Qwen3 on the cluster.
- **Orbital Chenguang (Beijing Orbital Twilight Technology):** A Beijing startup secured \$8.4bn in credit lines in April 2026 to build GW-scale orbital data centers.

Relevance to SpaceX:

- If the AI 'NIMBYism' trend continues to grow, we would expect to see further announcements/investments by AI firms geared towards space.
- Competitors who may not have previously thought about space may enter the arena.
- In our view helps validate SpaceX's investment and leadership in space-based AI infrastructure.
- Look to see continued Federal involvement in supporting space-based AI systems.

Exhibit 3: Why Space? – Think of Space as a Big, Cold, Sunny Backyard...

↗ **Big** = LEO alone is ~1.3 Trillion Cubic Kilometers

❄ **Cold** = Deep Space is 2.7 K (-270.5 deg C)

☀ **Sunny** = No atmospheric attenuation, day-night cycles, weather

🏠 **Backyard** = Earth's backyard, not YOUR backyard

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 4: Notable Ex-SpaceX US Orbital Compute Players

Google

Project Suncatcher

Plans to deploy satellites with TPUs alongside Planet Labs by early 2027

NVIDIA

Space-1 Vera Rubin

Integrated CPU-GPU module designed for space-based inference

BLUE ORIGIN

Project Sunrise

FCC filing for 51,600 satellite orbital computing constellation

Starcloud

Starcloud-1

Launched a nanosatellite with an H100 to space. Became 1st to train an LLM in orbit

Relativity

Reportedly Acquired by Former Google CEO Eric Schmidt for Orbital Datacenters*

Note: * Relativity Space was acquired by Eric Schmidt in March 2025. In April 2025, Eric Schmidt responded to an X post suggesting that the reason for the acquisition was orbital datacenters with the single word, "Yes."

Source: Company Data, Company announcements, Morgan Stanley Research

Valuation Methodology and Risks

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O)

Sum-of-the-Parts by Segment: Space, Connectivity, AI (Divided into X & Grok and Enterprise AI)

- \$300 Price Target = sum of Space (\$8), Connectivity (\$128), X & Grok (\$12), Enterprise AI (\$152)

2040 ending forecast period

6/30/2027 valuation date

11.1% WACC; 11.9% Cost of Equity

50% Enterprise AI valuation discount for execution risk

TGR of: 4.0% Space, 4.5% connectivity, 3.0% X & Grok, 5.0% Enterprise AI

Equates to 0.41 EV/EBIT/Growth

Risks to Upside

- Faster Starship reuse progress
- Faster Starlink capacity growth
- Stronger DTC / enterprise adoption
- More neocloud wins
- Cursor ARR acceleration
- Lower AI infrastructure time to power and cost

Risks to Downside

- Slower Starship reuse cadence
- Slower Starlink subscriber growth
- Weaker enterprise AI monetization
- Higher capex / cost per watt of compute
- Longer time-to-power
- Greater funding needs / dilution
- Regulatory delays

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(as of June 30, 2026)

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Coverage Universe			Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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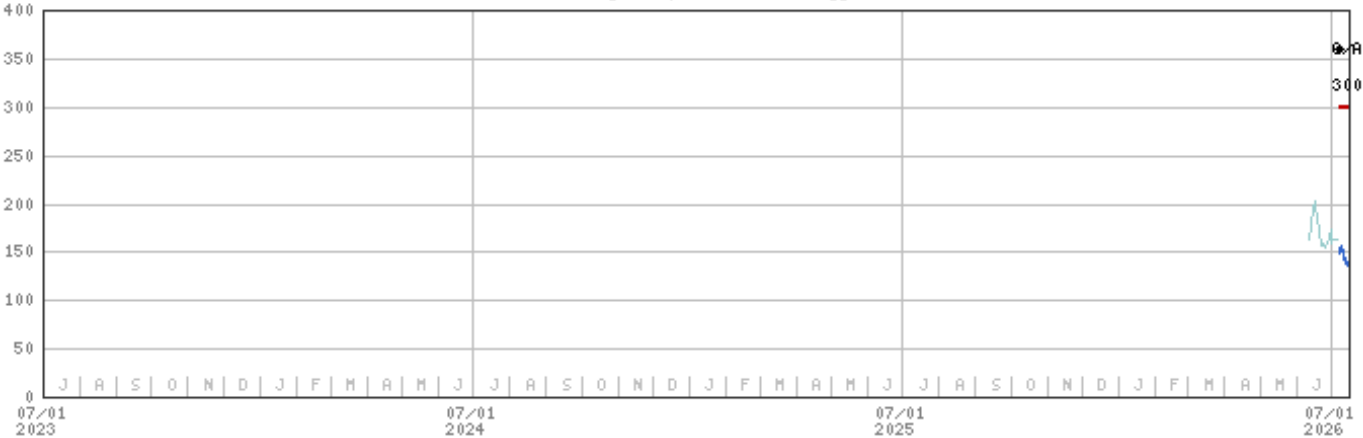
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Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O) - As of 07/15/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Space Technology



Stock Rating History: 7/7/26 : O/A
Price Target History: 7/7/26 : 300

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Space Technology

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/15/2026)
Adam Jonas, CFA		
Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O)	O (07/07/2026)	\$135.27
Justin M Lang		

Gogo Inc (GOGO.O)	E (08/14/2025)	\$3.55
Iridium Communications Inc (IRDM.O)	E (01/16/2026)	\$48.67
MDA Space Ltd (MDA.TO)	O (01/16/2026)	C\$46.60
Viasat Inc (VSAT.O)	E (12/15/2017)	\$70.44
Kristine T Liwag		
Firefly Aerospace Inc (FLY.O)	E (09/02/2025)	\$20.94
HawkEye 360 Inc (HAWK.N)	O (06/01/2026)	\$20.25
Planet Labs PBC (PL.N)	E (01/22/2023)	\$24.90
Rocket Lab USA Inc (RKLB.O)	O (01/16/2026)	\$76.20
Virgin Galactic Holdings Inc (SPCE.N)	U (11/22/2023)	\$2.71
Voyager Technologies Inc (VOYG.N)	U (07/15/2026)	\$26.60

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.

* Historical prices are not split adjusted.